

Single Source Justification (Simplified Acquisition)

Section A: General Contract Information

Is this a Bridge Action as defined in the [AF Bridge Action Reduction Plan](#)?

☐ Yes

☒ No

Contracting Activity: AFTC/PZZF

Project/Program Name: Missile Defense Agency

Purchase Request / Local ID Number: F1S0AY6084A001 / ACQ-26-H24

Estimated Contract Cost (including Options): [REDACTED]

Section B: Description of the Supplies/Services Required

This requirement is for the one-time, firm-fixed-price acquisition of custom-manufactured C-17 Air Drop System (ADS) Link Calibration adapters. These adapters are mission-essential hardware required to enable the use of the government's recently acquired 70,000 lb. capacity calibration machine. The machine was procured to overcome the 30,000 lb. limitation of the previous equipment, but it cannot interface with the C-17 ADS Links without these specific adapters. The acquisition of this hardware will allow the government to perform the recurring ADS Link calibration service in-house, replacing a previously outsourced process and leveraging a significant capital investment to improve efficiency.

Section C: Justification for Soliciting from a Single Source or Brand Name

In accordance with RFO 12.102(a), this acquisition will be conducted on a sole-source basis, as only one source is reasonably available. The adapters must be manufactured to the exact proprietary specifications of the government's OEM Instron calibration machine (procured in FY25 under FA930225P0095). Instron is the only company that possesses the required proprietary drawings and "fit and form" data needed to guarantee a correct and safe interface. The government does not own this technical data and cannot provide it to other vendors, which makes it impossible for any competitor to manufacture the item without introducing unacceptable technical and financial risk.

The mission impact and financial benefits further compel this sole-source approach. These adapters are critical for calibrating C-17 Air Drop System (ADS) Links, which directly support future Missile Defense Agency (MDA) test projects. An improperly manufactured part could damage the calibration machine or jeopardize test outcomes. By procuring from Instron, the government obtains a full performance guarantee, mitigating this risk. Furthermore, this one-time purchase will enable the government to bring the calibration process in-house, eliminating an approximately \$10,000 annual cost for outsourcing the service to NASA and ensuring a full return on the initial investment in the machine.

Section D: Efforts to Obtain Competition

We contacted three other sources, one being a local one, that has been used in the past for other adapter build ups. We would have to provide them the materials and they did not guarantee the work nor the materials if they were to break during the manufacturing process. We then reached out to Instron and they have the ability to manufacture the adapters for us as they specialize in making adapters for their calibration machines and they guarantee their work. The cost of material is also included in their quote. We also contacted two additional sources but they did not add the cost of materials in their quotes.

Section E: Steps to Preclude Future Single Source or Brand Name Awards

The root cause of this sole-source requirement is the lack of a government-owned technical data package (TDP) for the Instron calibration machine and its accessories. To proactively address this for future requirements, the following steps will be taken:

Inquire About Data Rights: During this acquisition, the Contracting Officer and technical team will formally inquire with Instron regarding the availability and cost of obtaining a government-purpose rights license for the adapter's design. While it is anticipated that the data may not be available or may be cost-prohibitive, this action and the vendor's official response will be

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documented in the contract file to inform future acquisition strategies.

Update Future System Requirements: The program office will ensure that any future requirement for a new or replacement calibration system includes a specific line item and evaluation factor for the delivery of a complete TDP for the base system and all necessary accessories. This will secure the government's ability to compete follow-on requirements for sustainment, replacement parts, and accessories.

Section F: Contracting Officer's Determination

I have determined, in accordance with [FAR 13.106-1\(b\)\(1\)](#), that the circumstances of this contract action deem only a single source is reasonably available.

Date	Typed Name and Rank/Grade of Contracting Officer
06-Apr-2026	Christina Day NH-III/ Contracting Officer